

MICHAEL R. HENDERSON

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Strategic and visionary Senior Engineering Manager with over 12 years of experience leading high-performance engineering organizations in fast-paced, global environments. Proven track record of scaling engineering teams from 10 to 100+ members while maintaining high velocity and technical excellence. Expert in driving digital transformation, cloud migrations, and microservices architecture at enterprise scale. A dedicated leader focused on fostering a culture of ownership, psychological safety, and continuous improvement. Highly skilled in balancing business objectives with technical debt, managing multi-million dollar budgets, and partnering with C-suite stakeholders to define and execute long-term product roadmaps. Specialized in Agile at Scale (SAFe), Site Reliability Engineering (SRE), and high-availability distributed systems.

STRATEGIC CORE COMPETENCIES

- **Organizational Leadership:** Engineering Management, Team Building & Scaling, Performance Management, Mentorship & Coaching, Strategic Planning.
- **Operational Excellence:** Agile/Scrum/Kanban at Scale, OKR (Objectives and Key Results) Implementation, Budgeting & P&L Management, Vendor Management.
- **Technical Oversight:** Cloud-Native Architecture (AWS/GCP/Azure), Microservices, CI/CD Pipelines, DevOps Culture, Cybersecurity Best Practices.
- **Product Strategy:** Roadmap Development, Stakeholder Alignment, User-Centric Design, Data-Driven Decision Making, Go-to-Market Execution.
- **Soft Skills:** Conflict Resolution, Crisis Management, Executive Communication, Change Management, Cross-Functional Collaboration.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Engineering Manager | DataScale Systems | Seattle, WA

May 2020 – Present

- **Organizational Scaling:** Built and managed a multi-disciplinary engineering organization of 65+ engineers across five squads. Successfully scaled the department by 40% within 12 months while reducing time-to-hire by 30%.
- **Platform Modernization:** Orchestrated the migration of a legacy on-premise data processing engine to a serverless AWS architecture, resulting in a \$2.5M annual reduction in infrastructure costs and a 10x increase in throughput.
- **Strategic Planning:** Collaborated with the CTO and VP of Product to define the 3-year technical roadmap, aligning engineering efforts with 20% annual revenue growth targets.
- **Process Optimization:** Introduced DORA metrics (Deployment Frequency, Lead Time for Changes, MTTR, Change Failure Rate) to track and improve engineering productivity, leading to a 25% improvement in delivery velocity.

- **Budget Oversight:** Manage an annual departmental budget of \$8M, including personnel, licensing, and infrastructure costs, consistently delivering within 2% of projections.
- **Incident Management:** Established a 24/7 on-call rotation and "Blameless Post-Mortem" culture, reducing P0 incident resolution time by 50%.

Engineering Manager | FinFlow Technologies | San Francisco, CA

January 2017 – April 2020

- **Team Development:** Led a high-impact team of 15 full-stack engineers in the development of a real-time financial transaction platform processing \$1B+ monthly.
- **Technical Leadership:** Directed the implementation of a GraphQL-based API layer, improving frontend performance by 40% and simplifying the integration process for external partners.
- **Agile Transformation:** Transitioned the engineering department from a waterfall-hybrid model to a pure Agile Scrum framework, increasing sprint predictability by 60%.
- **Mentorship:** Developed a structured career ladder and mentorship program; successfully promoted 4 junior engineers to senior-level roles within two years.
- **Security & Compliance:** Led the engineering efforts for SOC2 Type II and PCI-DSS compliance, implementing automated security scanning and rigorous code review standards.

Lead Software Engineer & Technical Manager | BlueOrigin Apps | Denver, CO

June 2013 – December 2016

- **Hands-on Leadership:** Managed a team of 8 while contributing to core architectural decisions for a mobile-first social networking application.
- **Infrastructure Automation:** Designed and implemented the first automated CI/CD pipeline using Jenkins and Docker, reducing deployment cycles from bi-weekly to daily.
- **Database Optimization:** Led the migration from a single-instance MySQL database to a sharded PostgreSQL cluster, resolving critical bottleneck issues during peak traffic.
- **Vendor Relations:** Negotiated contracts with cloud service providers and 3rd-party API vendors, saving the company \$150k annually.

LEADERSHIP CASE STUDIES

Case Study: Digital Transformation & Cloud Migration

The Challenge: The organization was hindered by a monolithic architecture hosted on-premise, leading to frequent downtime and an inability to scale during holiday shopping seasons.

The Solution:

- **Execution:** Led a "Tiger Team" to build a Proof of Concept (PoC) for a microservices-based architecture using Kubernetes on AWS EKS.
- **Change Management:** Conducted "Lunch and Learn" sessions to upskill the entire engineering staff in Go and Docker.
- **Phasing:** Adopted a "Canary Deployment" strategy to migrate 10% of traffic at a time, ensuring zero downtime for customers.

- **Result:** System availability increased to 99.99%. Deployment time dropped from 3 hours to 15 minutes. The platform successfully handled a 5x traffic spike during Black Friday without a single incident.

Case Study: Global Engineering Reorganization

The Challenge: Following a period of rapid hiring, the engineering team had become siloed, with redundant efforts and communication breakdowns between specialized departments.

The Solution:

- **Architecture:** Implemented "Spotify-style" Tribes, Squads, and Chapters to foster cross-functional collaboration.
- **Governance:** Introduced a "Technical RFC" process to ensure architectural consistency across the organization while allowing teams autonomy in implementation.
- **Measurement:** Developed an internal "Developer Happiness Survey" to measure cultural health and identify friction points.
- **Result:** Cross-team dependencies were reduced by 50%. Employee retention rates improved by 15% year-over-year.

MANAGEMENT PHILOSOPHY & LEADERSHIP STYLE

People First Approach

My management philosophy is built on the foundation of Servant Leadership. I believe that my primary role is to clear obstacles for my team, provide them with the resources they need, and step back to let them innovate.

- **Psychological Safety:** I foster an environment where failure is seen as a learning opportunity, not a cause for punishment.
- **Growth Mindset:** I prioritize budget for professional development, encouraging engineers to attend conferences and pursue certifications.
- **Radical Candor:** I practice giving and receiving direct, honest feedback to ensure constant growth and alignment.

Data-Driven Engineering Management

I believe that "what gets measured gets managed." I use a combination of qualitative and quantitative data to guide my decisions.

- **Velocity vs. Quality:** I track throughput alongside bug leakage rates to ensure we aren't sacrificing stability for speed.
- **Cycle Time Analysis:** I regularly audit our PR process to identify bottlenecks in the code review cycle.

TECHNICAL OVERSIGHT & ARCHITECTURAL EXPERTISE

Distributed Systems & Cloud

- **High Availability:** Designing active-active multi-region architectures.
- **Observability:** Expertise in implementing OpenTelemetry, Datadog, and New Relic for full-stack visibility.

- **Scalability Patterns:** Mastery of circuit breakers, rate limiting, and event-driven architecture (Kafka/RabbitMQ).

Security & Governance

- **Shift-Left Security:** Integrating SAST/DAST tools directly into the development lifecycle.
- **Identity Management:** Implementing Zero-Trust security models and advanced IAM policies.

EDUCATION & PROFESSIONAL CREDENTIALS

Education

Master of Science in Technology Management

University of Washington | 2013

Focus: Strategic Innovation and Engineering Leadership

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

Colorado State University | 2010

Professional Certifications

- Certified Scrum Master (CSM)
- AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Associate
- Google Cloud Professional Collaboration Engineer
- PMP – Project Management Professional (PMI)

THOUGHT LEADERSHIP & INDUSTRY PRESENCE

- **Author:** "The Scaling Manager" – A bi-weekly newsletter on Substack with 5,000+ subscribers.
- **Speaker:** "Leading Through Crisis: Engineering Management in 2024" – LeadDev West Coast.
- **Podcast Guest:** Featured on "The Engineering Leadership Podcast" discussing OKR pitfalls.

INDUSTRY CONTRIBUTIONS & VOLUNTEERING

- **Advisory Board:** Member of the Seattle Tech Council, advising local government on STEM education.
- **Mentor:** "Plato Mentor" – Providing 1:1 coaching to new engineering managers.
- **Open Source Governance:** Contributor to the "Engineering Manager Handbook" open-source project.

CAREER TIMELINE & KEY MILESTONES

- **2010-2012:** Software Engineer – Mastering the craft of development and clean code.
- **2013-2015:** Lead Engineer – Transitioning to technical mentorship and architecture.
- **2016-2018:** Engineering Manager – Mastering people management and Agile processes.
- **2019-2021:** Senior Manager – Scaling organizations and driving multi-cloud strategies.
- **2022-Present:** Executive Leadership – Strategic roadmap planning and P&L management.